KONSTANTIN ROKOSSOVSKY
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: IMPASSABLE (battlefield made with vidIQ; Rokossovsky's real public-domain 1945 photo added on top)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Rokossovsky-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 1108 MB)
Download	(not uploaded yet: waiting for the owner's OK)
Length	15:43
Voice	Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample, see note in chat)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: The Swamps No Army Could Cross
2:45	Move 1: The Volokolamsk Highway (Moscow 1941)
7:07	Move 2: The Northern Face of Kursk (1943)
11:10	Move 3: Operation Bagration (1944)
15:15	Legacy

Key frames (the hook)



2. Title and thumbnail

Title (locked, vidIQ score 93)

Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Destroyed Hitler's Strongest Army

Alternatives (vidIQ scores):

- Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke Army Group Centre (89)
- Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The General Better Than Zhukov (87)

Why this thumbnail

Tactical Genius picture formula: a dark aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows on the left, the commander on the right, a red brush banner bottom-left. **IMPASSABLE** is type 3 (ominous stakes): the Germans' belief about the Belarus swamps, the same promise as the hook and the title (the swamps no army could cross, Army Group Centre destroyed). No quote marks: it is not a verbatim quote.

Alternative for YouTube's Test & compare: **TWO BLOWS** (type 1, his decision against Stalin).



Checked: Bobruisk and Parichi labels (the AI image's own labels were removed: it had Parichi in the wrong place), swamp, log road and birch forest match Belarus 1944. The portrait is Rokossovsky's real 1945 photo (public domain), not an AI likeness; it shows him as a Marshal (he was made Marshal on 29 June 1944, during the battle).

Before uploading: check the thumbnail at small size on a phone.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound, archive and image licences require them.

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Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Destroyed Hitler's Strongest Army

About one in four people in Belarus would not survive the German occupation. In June 1944, the Red
Army came to drive the occupiers out, and in a single summer Army Group Centre lost around 400,000
men. It began in swamps the Germans were sure no army could cross.

Konstantin Rokossovsky went from a Soviet prison cell to three of the greatest battles of the
Second World War. In this video we break down his three greatest tactical moves: the elastic
defence of the Volokolamsk highway before Moscow in 1941, the defence of the northern face of the
Kursk salient at Ponyri and Olkhovatka in 1943, and the two-pronged breakthrough at Bobruisk during
Operation Bagration in 1944.

Bend, don't break. Read the blow before it lands. Strike where the map says you can't.

Which commander should we cover next? Let us know in the comments.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: The Swamps No Army Could Cross
1:53 Hitler Invades; the Road to Moscow
2:45 Move 1: The Volokolamsk Highway (Moscow 1941)
5:01 The Istra Reservoir: Rokossovsky vs Zhukov
6:13 The Counter-Attack
7:07 Move 2: The Northern Face of Kursk (1943)
8:47 Firing First: the Counter-Barrage
9:38 The Fight for Ponyri
11:10 Move 3: Operation Bagration (1944)
12:00 "Go and Think It Over": Two Blows
12:50 Out of the Marshes: Bobruisk
14:38 57,000 Prisoners in Moscow
15:15 Legacy

SOURCES
Konstantin Rokossovsky, A Soldier's Duty (memoirs, Progress Publishers)
David M. Glantz & Jonathan M. House, When Titans Clashed: How the Red Army Stopped Hitler (1995)
Boris Sokolov, Marshal K. K. Rokossovsky: The Red Army's Gentleman Commander (Helion)
Robert Forczyk, Moscow 1941: Hitler's First Defeat (Osprey, 2006)
Karl-Heinz Frieser et al., Germany and the Second World War, Vol. VIII (Oxford University Press)
G. F. Krivosheev (ed.), Soviet Casualties and Combat Losses in the Twentieth Century (1997)
Niklas Zetterling & Anders Frankson, Kursk 1943: A Statistical Analysis (2000)

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Map data ©
OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). Rivers and lakes on the overview map: Natural Earth (public
domain). Historical borders: aourednik/historical-basemaps.

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Aircraft and transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects
Free License). Other sound effects: original.

Images:
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 101I-212-0212A-19, photographer: Koch, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Erich Hoepner)
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 183-2005-1017-519, photographer: Fritz Lucke, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Walther Model)
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 101I-088-3724-06A, photographer: Thiemann, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Ernst Busch)
- Public domain: Soviet wartime photographs of K. Rokossovsky (Grigory Vayl), G. Zhukov (Grigory
Vayl), M. Katukov (Arkady Khodov), I. Panfilov (Mikhail Kalashnikov), B. Shaposhnikov; national
flags.
Archive film: "The Battle of Russia" (1943, US Army Special Service Division) and Army-Navy Screen
Magazine no. 47 (1944, US Army Signal Corps), US government works, public domain. Victory Parade
photographs: mil.ru / Russian Ministry of Defence, licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 (
one by Evgeny Khaldei).

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.
■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]
#Rokossovsky #OperationBagration #MilitaryHistory
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4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, ww2 documentary, eastern front, Konstantin Rokossovsky, Rokossovsky, Operation Bagration, Battle of Kursk, Battle of Moscow, Bobruisk, Ponyri, Army Group Centre, Georgy Zhukov, Walther Model, Red Army, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, ww2 animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Rokossovsky, Volokolamsk, Hoepner, Ponyri, Olkhovatka, Bobruisk, Bagration, Parichi, Rogachev, Shaposhnikov)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which commander should we cover next? Zhukov, Konev, Manstein, Model...?
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (single source, memoir-based or approximate; see research/FACT_NOTES.md):
• The Istra-reservoir episode (Zhukov refused, Shaposhnikov approved, Zhukov cancelled) and the "two blows" meeting with Stalin both come from Rokossovsky's own memoirs; Zhukov disputed them (the script says so).
• Torture details: from the family's account (teeth, ribs, two mock executions), worded as such.
• Kryukovo / Istra retaken ~8 / ~11 December 1941 (map labels).
• German 9th Army losses at Kursk shown as ~20,000-23,000 (Frieser / Zetterling range).
• Bobruisk pocket ~50,000 killed and ~20,000 captured (Wikipedia, Bobruysk offensive); no reliable Soviet figure, shown as a dash.
• ~400,000 German losses = whole Operation Bagration (Frieser 399,102), stated as such.
• All front lines are approximate (logged per date in research/FACT_NOTES_*.md).